THE HOLY QURAN

INTRODUCTION, REVELATION AND COMPILATION

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define the Quran and its significance as the ultimate source of guidance for Muslims.
- Learn about the stages and timeline of the Quranic revelation.
- Understand the Quran's linguistic features, classical Arabic, and its structure of Surahs and Ayahs.
- Study how the Quran was preserved during the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ's life and the roles of Abu Bakr (RA) and Uthman (RA) in its compilation.
- Explore how the Quran has been preserved through oral and written transmission and remains unchanged and universally accepted.

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OVERVIEW

The Holy Quran is the sacred text of Islam, in this lecture we focusing on its significance, revelation, preservation, and compilation. The historical process of how the Quran was revealed over 23 years to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and how it was preserved both orally and in written form during his life and the eras of Caliphs Abu Bakr (RA) and Uthman (RA). It emphasizes the divine promise that the Quran will remain unchanged and universally accepted, making it a foundational text for Muslims worldwide. It guides Muslims in all aspects of life spiritual, moral, and social.

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THE HOLY QURAN



- Introduction
- Revelation
- Names of Quran
- Meaning
- Definition
- Compilation
- Basic Concepts of Quran
- Subject of Quran

Who is the author of the Quran?

The author of the Holy Quran is none other than Allah Almighty. He revealed the Book to the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him), through Gabriel, over a period of 22 years, 6 months and few days.

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INTRODUCTION

There are 114 Surah's in the Holy Quran while by Surah means status, height, pitch, boundary, 'elevation and mercy. By Surah, it is meant to be a chapter. In every Surah, there are verses called "Ayahs". By Ayah means sign or miracle. It means every Ayah of the Holy Quran is a sign of the Greatness of Allah. And every Ayah is a miracle in such a way that no creature among men, jins and angels can create such an Ayah.

The Holy Quran is divided into 30 parts called "Paras" and 7 Divisions each called "Manzil". The Holy Quran first started revealing at the age of 40 to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

While the Holy Prophet ﷺ was in cave Hira three miles away from the Holy Makkah.

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DIVINE REVELATION

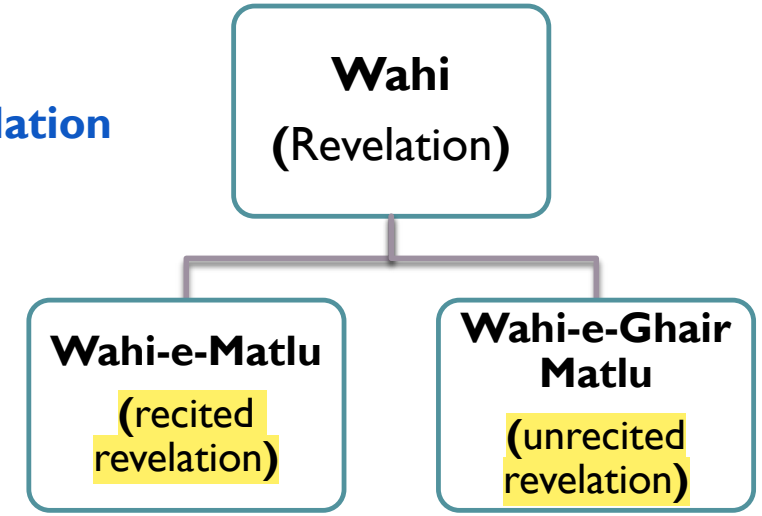
Revelation (وَحي) :

The Arabic word **Wahi** (وَحْي)comes from the root word (وَحىٰ) waha and is used to describe divine revelation. It has a variety of different meanings in the Arabic language, being interpreted as "a quick or divine indication", "to give or convey a message" or "gentle speech".

اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ - خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ - اقْرَأْ وَرَبُّكَ الْأَكْرَمُ -
الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ - عَلَّمَ الْإِنسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ

"Read! In the Name of your Lord, Who has created (all that exists), Has created man from a clot. Read! And your Lord is the Most Generous, Who has taught (the writing) by the pen. Has taught man that which he knew not," [Al-'Alaq 96: 1-5].

Types of Revelation



First Revelation

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NAMES OF THE HOLY QUR'AN

* Al' Shifa (Healing, The Cure) - (10:57) (17:82) (41:44)
* Al-Kitab (The Scripture) - (21:10)
* Al-Noor (The Light) - (7:157)
* Al-Hukm (The Judgment) - (13:37)
* Al-Zhikr (The Reminder) - (15:9)
* Al-Furqan (The Criterion for judging right from wrong) - (25:1)
* Al-Tanzil (The Revelation) - (26:192)



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The Meaning of Word "Quran"

- The word "Quran (قرآن)" a verbal noun, is equivalent in meaning to "Qira'ah (قِرَأَةٌ)" as both come from the verb "Qara'a (قَرَأَ)" which means "to read" and also used in the meaning of "to collect" or "to compile".
- That is Quran literally means "A Reading or Reciting".
- The term "Quran" has been historically used specifically to refer to the book which was revealed to Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ).

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DEFINITION OF QURAN



What is the definition of Quran?

"Quran is the word of Allah (kalamu Allah) as revealed to his Prophet Mohammad (ﷺ) through the Angel Gabriel, transferred to us through narration chains known as "Tawator", recited as a form of worship, Beginning with Surat Al'Fatihah and ending with Surat An-Nas, and challenging with its shortest Sura."

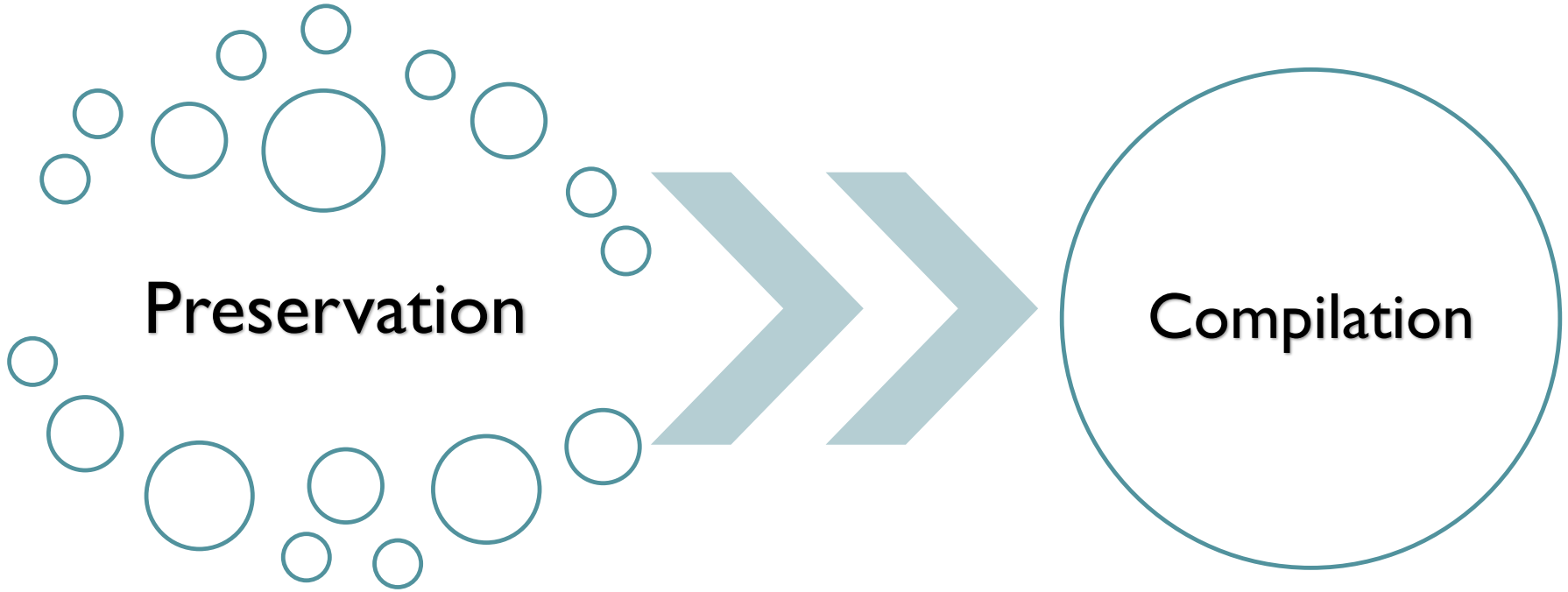
القرآن الكريم:

هو كلام الله تعالى المعجز المنزّل على خاتم الأنبياء والمرسلين سيدنا محمد صلّى الله عليه وسلم بواسطة أمين الوحي جبريل عليه السلام المنقول إلينا بالتواتر، المتعبد بتلاوته، المبدوء بسورة الفاتحة والمختتم بسورة الناس، والمتحدى بأقصر سورة منه.

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HISTORY OF QURAN



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THE PRESERVATION

- The Quran will always be protected from change and alterations, for Allah said,

إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا ٱلذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُۥ لَحَٰفِظُونَ (٩)

"It is certainly We Who have revealed the Reminder, and it is certainly We Who will preserve it." [15:9].

- The Quran is free from contradictions, for Allah said,

أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ ٱلْقُرْءَانَ ۚ وَلَوْ كَانَ مِنْ عِندِ غَيْرِ ٱللَّهِ لَوَجَدُوا۟ فِيهِ ٱخْتِلَٰفًا كَثِيرًا (٨٢)

"Do they not then reflect on the Quran? Had it been from anyone other than Allah, they would have certainly found in it many inconsistencies." [4:82].

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- **The Blessings of Reciting the Quran Together**

When people come together to learn and teach the Quran, Allah will send down tranquility, mercy, angels and make mention of them to those in His proximity.

The messenger of Allah said, what translated means,

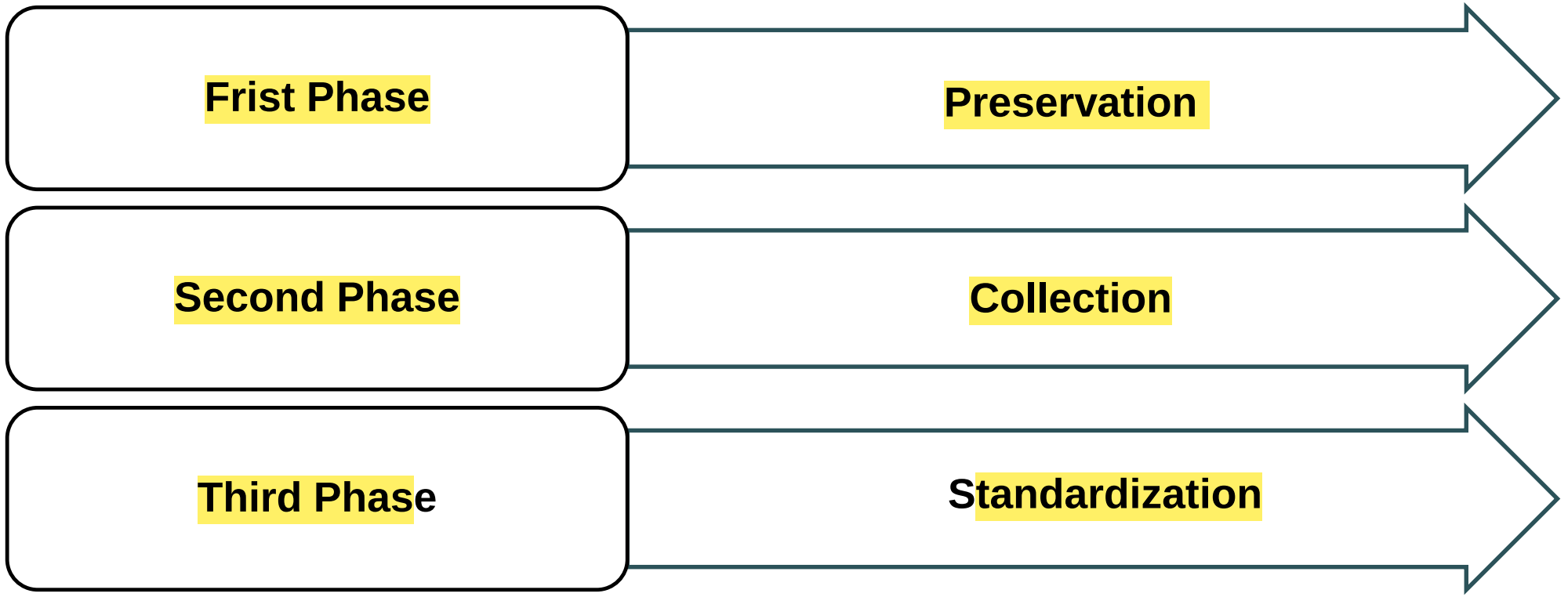
وعن أبي هريرة رضي الله عنه قال: قال رسول الله ﷺ : ما اجتمع قوم في بيت من بيوت الله يتلون كتاب الله، ويتدارسونه بينهم، إلا نزلت عليهم السكينة، وغشيتهم الرحمة، وحفتهم الملائكة، وذكرهم الله فيمن عنده۔

(رواه مسلم)

Abu Hurairah (May Allah be pleased with him) reported: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "Any group of people that assemble in one of the Houses of Allah to recite the Book of Allah, learning and teaching it, tranquility will descend upon them, mercy will engulf them, angels will surround them and Allah will make mention of them to those (the angels) in His proximity". [Muslim].

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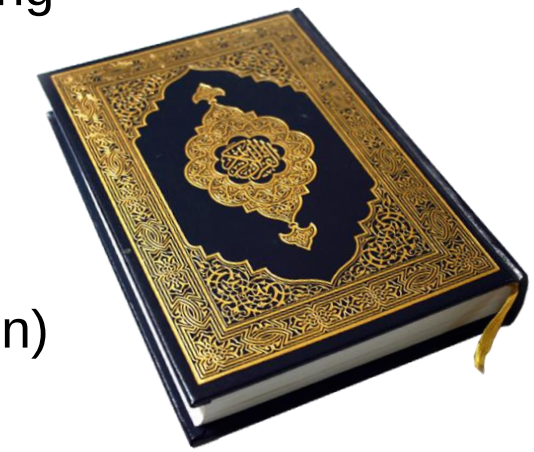
COMPILATION OF QURAN



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Phases of Compilation

The Quran's composition may be subdivided up into different phases. First, there was the Prophet's lifetime (PBUH). Then, during Abu Bakr's Caliphate, the compilation into the correct form took place. The final compilation of the Quran and its distribution to various regions of the Muslim state then took place during the Caliphate of Uthman (RA).



1: Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ)'s Time

2: Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA)'s Caliphate (Collection of Quran)

3: Hazrat Uthman ibn Affan (RA)'s Caliphate (Standardization & Distribution)

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FRIST PHASE
LIFE OF HOLY PROPHET MUHAMMAD ﷺ

The First Memorizer of the complete Quran.

لَا تُحَرِّكۡ بِهٖ لِسَانَكَ لِتَعۡجَلَ بِهٖؕ ﴿75:16﴾ اِنَّ عَلَيۡنَا جَمۡعَهٗ وَقُرۡاٰنَهٗۚ ۖ ﴿75:17﴾ فَاِذَا قَرَاۡنٰهُ فَاتَّبِعۡ قُرۡاٰنَهٗ ﴿75:18﴾ ثُمَّ اِنَّ عَلَيۡنَا بَيَانَهٗؕ ﴿75:19﴾

“[O prophet] Do not move your tongue swiftly to acquire this [Qur’an]. Verily, upon us is its collection and recital. So when we have recited it, follow this recital [of ours]. Then upon us is to explain it [wherever need be].” (Qur’an, 75:16-19)

Gabriel used to repeat the recitation of the Qur'an with Prophet Muhammad ﷺ once a year, but he repeated it twice with him in the year he (Prophet Muhammad ﷺ) died'

Abu Hurayrah, collected in Sahih Al-Bukhari, 6.520.

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The main method of learning was via memorization. This was a tradition among the Arabs. That was because they had a strong inclination toward poetry. Memorization and recitation were the main methods of discussion and socializing. Hence, Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) would memorize the passages of the Quran as Allah revealed them to him. He would then recite the verses to the companions and explain them as well.

Zaid ibn Thabit (RA) was one of the most prominent scribes who would take down the Quran in the presence of the Prophet (PBUH). It was at this point when the names of the Surahs were likely stated and noted down. Additionally, Angel Jibrail (AS) would visit the Prophet (PBUH) every Ramadan and listen to him reciting the whole Quran. In the final year of his life, they went over it twice.

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SECOND PHASE
ERA OF ABU BAKAR (رضي الله عنه)

The First Single Volume Manuscript of the Qur'an

There was one main event that caused a radical change in the compilation of the Quran during this period. After the Prophet (PBUH) passed away, Abu Bakr became the Caliph of the state. However, the transition wasn't very smooth. A number of tribes that had peace treaties with the Muslims began to back out. They stated that their treaty was only with the Prophet (PBUH). Hence, they came up with demands such as refusing to pay Zakat, etc.

The Battle of Yamama

The Battle of Yamama was fought between Muslims and rebels led by Musailmah. This battle would play a vital role in the compilation of the Quran. More than 70 memorizers were martyred during this battle, which led to the collection and compilation of the Qur'an.

Umar bin Khattab was saddened by the casualties the Muslims suffered during the Battle of Yamama. He realized that there was no permanent book form version of Allah's Word. After the death of more than 70 huffaz (memorizers of the Quran), it was imperative that the Muslims compile the Quran.

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THIRD PHASE STANDARDIZATION

Uthman ibn Affan (RA)’s Caliphate

- After Abu Bakr’s Caliphate, Islam spread far and wide in the Caliphate of Hazrat Umar. Then, Hazrat Usman was the third caliph of Islam, ruling from 644 to 656 CE. His caliphate witnessed the rapid expansion of the Muslim empire and an increasing number of non-Arab Muslims. The compilation of the Quran during the time of Hazrat Usman (Uthman ibn Affan) is an important event in Islamic history.

- Hudhaifah bin Yaman, one of the companions who had travelled during the Muslims' conquests, noticed this and related the concerns to the Caliph Hazrat Uthman. Hazrat Usman took the initiative to compile a standardized version. He appointed a committee of skilled scribes, headed by Zaid ibn Thabit, a close companion of the Prophet Muhammad and one of the primary scribes of the revelations during his lifetime.

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CONTINUE…

- Hazrat Usman’s compilation played a crucial role in preserving the Quran in its original form and language. It eliminated potential variations and discrepancies, ensuring that Muslims had access to a consistent and authentic version of the Quran regardless of their geographic location. This compilation became the basis for the preservation of the Quran for generations to come.

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BASIC CONCEPTS OF QURAN

- The Concept of Religion
- The concept of Life
- The concept of Faith (ایمان)
- The concept of Tawheed (توحید)
- The Concept of Prophethood
- The concept of Qadar (Fate or Predestination) (قضاء /قدر)
- The concept of Righteousness (البر)
- The concept of Taqwa (تقوىٰ)
- The Concept of Sin
- The concept of Education or Ilm (العلم)

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SUBJECT OF QURAN



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THANK YOU

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